SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

17 March 2020 · Shift 1

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 51 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. EXTENSIVE

(A) Intensive
(B) Lengthy
(C) Intricate
(D) Elaborate

Q.2

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. TRUST (n)

(A) Safety
(B) Welfare
(C) Belief
(D) Ability

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Several environmentalists from the city conducted a meet to discuss issues related to the _____ pollution levels created by the growing number of pharmaceutical companies.

(A) raise in
(B) rise in
(C) rising from
(D) raising of

Q.4

Select the word with the incorrect spelling.

(A) Quantity
(B) Argument
(C) Quarrell
(D) Aisle

Q.5

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One of the most fascinating archaeological sites in Maharashtra, the Ellora Caves, date back (1)_____ about 1,500 years ago, and (2)_____ the epitome of Indian rock-cut architecture. (3)_____ 34 caves are actually Buddhist, Hindu and Jain religious monuments (4)_____ in the rock. They were given the (5)_____ of World Heritage Site in 1983. Created between the 6th and 10th century, the 12 Buddhist, 17 Hindu and 5 Jain caves carved in proximity at Ellora are proof of the religious harmony prevalent during this period of Indian history.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1.

(A) at
(B) for
(C) to
(D) in

Q.6

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One of the most fascinating archaeological sites in Maharashtra, the Ellora Caves, date back (1)_____ about 1,500 years ago, and (2)_____ the epitome of Indian rock-cut architecture. (3)_____ 34 caves are actually Buddhist, Hindu and Jain religious monuments (4)_____ in the rock. They were given the (5)_____ of World Heritage Site in 1983. Created between the 6th and 10th century, the 12 Buddhist, 17 Hindu and 5 Jain caves carved in proximity at Ellora are proof of the religious harmony prevalent during this period of Indian history.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2.

(A) is
(B) be
(C) were
(D) are

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One of the most fascinating archaeological sites in Maharashtra, the Ellora Caves, date back (1)_____ about 1,500 years ago, and (2)_____ the epitome of Indian rock-cut architecture. (3)_____ 34 caves are actually Buddhist, Hindu and Jain religious monuments (4)_____ in the rock. They were given the (5)_____ of World Heritage Site in 1983. Created between the 6th and 10th century, the 12 Buddhist, 17 Hindu and 5 Jain caves carved in proximity at Ellora are proof of the religious harmony prevalent during this period of Indian history.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3.

(A) Many
(B) The
(C) An
(D) Few

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One of the most fascinating archaeological sites in Maharashtra, the Ellora Caves, date back (1)_____ about 1,500 years ago, and (2)_____ the epitome of Indian rock-cut architecture. (3)_____ 34 caves are actually Buddhist, Hindu and Jain religious monuments (4)_____ in the rock. They were given the (5)_____ of World Heritage Site in 1983. Created between the 6th and 10th century, the 12 Buddhist, 17 Hindu and 5 Jain caves carved in proximity at Ellora are proof of the religious harmony prevalent during this period of Indian history.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4.

(A) carved
(B) created
(C) erected
(D) constructed

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One of the most fascinating archaeological sites in Maharashtra, the Ellora Caves, date back (1)_____ about 1,500 years ago, and (2)_____ the epitome of Indian rock-cut architecture. (3)_____ 34 caves are actually Buddhist, Hindu and Jain religious monuments (4)_____ in the rock. They were given the (5)_____ of World Heritage Site in 1983. Created between the 6th and 10th century, the 12 Buddhist, 17 Hindu and 5 Jain caves carved in proximity at Ellora are proof of the religious harmony prevalent during this period of Indian history.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5.

(A) role
(B) symbol
(C) status
(D) function

Q.10

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. Ibn Al-Haitham wrote a book in seven volumes namely ‘Kitāb al-Manāẓir’ also known as ‘The Book of Optics.’ B. However, during the medieval period, the notable work of an Arab writer and scientist, Ibn Al-Haitham revolutionised the concept of physics. C. During the ancient period, the development of Physics took place simultaneously with the development of astronomy. D. In this book, Ibn Al-Haitham disproved the ancient Greek concept of vision and introduced a new theory.

(A) BCDA
(B) CBAD
(C) ADBC
(D) ACBD

Q.11

Select the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error. Did you know whether we can exchange the dress if my sister doesn’t like it?

(A) we can exchange the dress
(B) Did you know whether
(C) if my sister
(D) doesn’t like it

Q.12

Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case there is no improvement select ‘No improvement’. I had “no informations about” the bank strike so I went there yesterday.

(A) no information about
(B) not got informations about
(C) No improvement
(D) no informations concerning

Q.13

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. A large natural or artificial lake used as a source of water supply

(A) Reservoir
(B) Pool
(C) Creek
(D) Pond

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. ALLURING

(A) Deceitful
(B) Distracting
(C) Cheating
(D) Attractive

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. A lot of work has gone on “behind the scenes” for the special event which is being planned next week.

(A) For spreading the news
(B) In the theatre
(C) Unknown to everyone
(D) To complete the arrangements

Q.16

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. “Hats off to” someone

(A) Give hats to
(B) Announce a prize for
(C) Make new hats for
(D) Congratulations to

Q.17

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. “It is mine. I saw it first," claimed one cat. B. Suddenly they spotted a loaf of bread lying beneath a tree. C. Once upon a time, two cats were passing through a street. D. Both pounced upon it and caught the loaf at the same time.

(A) ADBC
(B) DBCA
(C) BADC
(D) CBDA

Q.18

Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case there is no improvement select 'No improvement'. Harry and Meghan "have decided to work and become" financially independent.

(A) have decided to work and became
(B) have decide to work and become
(C) No improvement
(D) has decided to work and become

Q.19

Select the option that is the direct form of the sentence. The doctor advised Jaya to put the eye drops into her eyes four times a day from the next day.

(A) The doctor had advised Jaya, "From the next day you put the eye drops into your eyes four times a day."
(B) The doctor advised Jaya, "From tomorrow put the eye drops into your eyes four times a day."
(C) The doctor advises Jaya, "From the next day put the eye drops into your eyes four times a day."
(D) The doctor advised Jaya, "From tomorrow put the eye drops into her eyes four times a day."

Q.20

Select the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error. They had to wait for the luggages to be put into the cab before they themselves got into it.

(A) to be put into the cab
(B) for the luggages
(C) They had to wait
(D) before they themselves got into it

Q.21

Select the option that is the passive form of the sentence. The sub-committee is presenting its report in a week's time.

(A) The report of the sub-committee has been presented in a week's time.
(B) The report of the sub-committee is being presented in a week's time.
(C) The report of the sub-committee is presenting in a week's time.
(D) The report of the sub-committee had been presented in a week's time.

Q.22

Select the wrongly spelt word.

(A) Extempore
(B) Expidition
(C) Experiment
(D) Extinct

Q.23

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. ABBREVIATE

(A) Oppose
(B) Challenge
(C) Dispute
(D) Expand

Q.24

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Close fitting cover for a sword or knife

(A) Shield
(B) Screen
(C) Sheath
(D) Guard

Q.25

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Astronomy enthusiasts and sky gazers will be able to watch six eclipses in 2020, but only three of them are expected to be _____ in India.

(A) exposed
(B) evident
(C) revealed
(D) visible

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1
Which is the largest river island in the world?

(A) Majuli Island
(B) Srirangam Island
(C) Agatti Island
(D) Bhavani Island

Q.2
Which of the following is a water soluble vitamin?

(A) Vitamin C
(B) Vitamin D
(C) Vitamin A
(D) Vitamin K

Q.3
Which of the following is a pension scheme introduced by the Government of India exclusively for senior citizens in May 2017?

(A) PMGAY
(B) PMVVY
(C) PMMVY
(D) PMGSY

Q.4
Mekhela Chador' is a traditional dress from the state of:

(A) Tripura
(B) Odisha
(C) West Bengal
(D) Assam

Q.5
_____ is the tube that carries urine from the kidney to the urinary bladder.

(A) Ureter
(B) Urethra
(C) Sphincter
(D) Aorta

Q.6
As of January 2020, who held the title of India's youngest chess grandmaster?

(A) D Gukesh
(B) Rameshbabu Praggnanandhaa
(C) Viswanathan Anand
(D) Parimarjan Negi

Q.7
Which of the following is an example of a Chola empire temple?

(A) Badami cave temple
(B) Chennakesava temple
(C) Airavateswara temple
(D) Virupaksha temple

Q.8
Flagella are the hair-like structures which act as organelles of locomotion in which of the following organisms?

(A) Amoeba
(B) Bacteria
(C) Virus
(D) Paramecium

Q.9
River Sharavati plunges as which of the following waterfalls?

(A) Soochipara
(B) Athirapally
(C) Hogenakkal
(D) Gerusoppe

Q.10
In which city is Indian Railway-Rail Coach Factory located?

(A) Kapurthala
(B) Chennai
(C) Bengaluru
(D) Chittaranjan

Q.11
What was the weight of the Chandraayan-2 spacecraft launched in July 2019?

(A) 3.3 tonne
(B) 3.8 tonne
(C) 4.3 tonne
(D) 2.9 tonne

Q.12
In which year was UNICEF founded?

(A) 1948
(B) 1946
(C) 1945
(D) 1949

Q.13
As of Feb 2020, how many members represent the state of Uttar Pradesh in Lok Sabha?

(A) 48
(B) 80
(C) 62
(D) 39

Q.14
Who among the following is the co-founder of Twitter?

(A) Tim Berners-Lee
(B) Jack Dorsey
(C) Narayan Murthy
(D) Bill Gates

Q.15
As of January 2020, who held the national record in both, 800 m and 1500 m sprint events?

(A) Ayyasamy Dharun
(B) Avinash Sable
(C) Muhammad Anas
(D) Jinson Johnson

Q.17
Laterite soil is rich in:

(A) Potassium
(B) Iron oxide
(C) Phosphorus
(D) Calcium carbonate

Q.18
Who is the author of the book 'Kerala: God's Own Country'?

(A) Thakazhi Sivasankara Pillai
(B) Shashi Tharoor
(C) Sudha Murthy
(D) Jeet Thayil

Q.19
Which of the following states is included in the sixth schedule of the Constitution of India?

(A) Nagaland
(B) Manipur
(C) Mizoram
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Q.20
When is 'International Ozone Day' celebrated?

(A) 2 October
(B) 31 October
(C) 9 August
(D) 16 September

Q.21
'Nibble' in computer terminology is also called _____.

(A) Bit
(B) Half bit
(C) Half byte
(D) Byte

Q.22

Where is the tomb of Sher Shah Suri located?

(A) Rohtasgarh
(B) Sasaram
(C) Chausa
(D) Delhi

Q.23

As of January 2020, who was the president of the BCCI?

(A) Ravi Shastri
(B) Sourav Ganguly
(C) Sunil Gavaskar
(D) Harsha Bogle

Q.24

Who among the following received the Padma Bhushan in 2019?

(A) Sunil Chhetri
(B) Bhupen Hazarika
(C) Mohanlal Viswanathan
(D) Virat Kohli

Q.25

As of January 2020, who is the managing director of YES Bank?

(A) Aditya Puri
(B) Ravneet Gill
(C) Arundhati Bhattacharya
(D) Amitabh Chaudhry

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (A) Intensive

'Extensive' means covering a large area or range; 'intensive' means concentrated on a small one, as in extensive and intensive farming. 'Lengthy' and 'elaborate' are close to 'extensive', and 'intricate' means complicated.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Belief

'Trust' as a noun is a firm belief in someone's honesty or reliability: 'belief'.

Q.3 · Answer (B) rise in

'Rise' is the noun for an increase, and an increase is 'in' something: 'the rise in pollution levels'. 'Raise' is the verb meaning to lift, and 'rising from' gives the wrong sense.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Quarrell

The correct spelling is 'quarrel', with one 'l' at the end.

Q.5 · Answer (C) to

To 'date back to' a time is to have existed since then: the caves 'date back to about 1,500 years ago'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) are

The plural subject 'the Ellora Caves' takes 'are': 'and are the epitome of Indian rock-cut architecture'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) The

The 34 caves are a definite group, the caves of Ellora already named, so they take the definite article: 'The 34 caves'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) carved

Rock-cut monuments are 'carved' in the rock, as the passage later says of the caves 'carved in proximity at Ellora'.

Q.9 · Answer (C) status

A site is given the 'status' of World Heritage Site.

Q.10 · Answer (B) CBAD

C opens with physics in the ancient period; B turns ('However') to the medieval work of Ibn Al-Haitham; A names his book; D says what 'this book' did: CBAD.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Did you know whether

The question is about whether the dress can be exchanged now, so the verb must be present: 'Do you know whether we can exchange the dress if my sister doesn't like it?'

Q.12 · Answer (A) no information about

'Information' is uncountable and has no plural: 'I had no information about the bank strike'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Reservoir

A reservoir is a large natural or artificial lake that stores water for supply. A creek is a narrow inlet or stream, and a pond and a pool are small.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Attractive

'Alluring' means attractive or tempting.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Unknown to everyone

Work done 'behind the scenes' is done in private, out of public view; of the options, 'unknown to everyone' comes closest to this.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Congratulations to

'Hats off to' someone is said to praise or congratulate them, as if raising one's hat in respect.

Q.17 · Answer (D) CBDA
C introduces the two cats, B has them spot the loaf, D has both pounce on it at once, and A gives the quarrel that follows: CBDA.

Q.18 · Answer (C) No improvement
The sentence is correct: the plural subject takes 'have', and 'to work and become' joins two infinitives after 'decided'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) The doctor advised Jaya, “From tomorrow put the eye drops into your eyes four times a day.”
In direct speech 'from the next day' becomes 'from tomorrow' and 'her eyes' becomes 'your eyes', as the doctor speaks to Jaya; the reporting verb stays in the past.

Q.20 · Answer (B) for the luggages
'Luggage' is an uncountable noun and has no plural: 'They had to wait for the luggage to be put into the cab'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) The report of the sub-committee is being presented in a week’s time.
The present continuous 'is presenting' becomes 'is being presented' in the passive: 'The report of the sub-committee is being presented in a week's time.'

Q.22 · Answer (B) Expidition
The correct spelling is 'expedition'.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Expand
To 'abbreviate' is to shorten; its opposite is to 'expand'.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Sheath
A sheath is a close-fitting cover for the blade of a sword or knife.

Q.25 · Answer (D) visible
Eclipses that can be seen from India are 'visible' there. 'Evident' means plain to the mind, and 'exposed' and 'revealed' mean uncovered.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Majuli Island
SSC's key gives Majuli, in the Brahmaputra in Assam, which Guinness World Records lists as the largest river island. (Brazil's Bananal Island, between the Araguaia and the Javaés, is larger by area and is also often given the title, but it is not among the options.)

Q.2 · Answer (A) Vitamin C
Vitamin C and the B vitamins dissolve in water; vitamins A, D, E and K are fat-soluble.

Q.3 · Answer (B) PMVVY
The Pradhan Mantri Vaya Vandana Yojana (PMVVY), launched in May 2017 and run by LIC, is a pension scheme for citizens aged 60 and above. PMMVY is a maternity benefit scheme, PMGSY builds rural roads and PMGAY rural houses.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Assam
The mekhela chador, a two-piece draped garment, is the traditional dress of Assamese women.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Ureter
Each ureter carries urine from a kidney to the urinary bladder; the urethra carries it out of the body from the bladder.

Q.6 · Answer (A) D Gukesh
D Gukesh became a grandmaster in January 2019, aged 12 years and 7 months, beating the Indian record Praggnanandhaa had set in 2018; he still held it in January 2020.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Airavateswara temple
The Airavatesvara temple at Darasuram, near Kumbakonam in Tamil Nadu, was built by the Chola king Rajaraja II in the 12th century. The Badami cave temples are Chalukya work, the Chennakesava temple at Belur is Hoysala, and the Virupaksha temples are at Pattadakal (Chalukya) and Hampi (Vijayanagara).

Q.8 · Answer (B) Bacteria
Many bacteria swim with flagella. Amoeba moves with pseudopodia and Paramecium with cilia, and a virus has no means of moving on its own.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Gerusoppe
The Sharavati plunges at Jog Falls in Shivamogga district, Karnataka, also called the Gerusoppe (Gersoppa) Falls. Athirapally and Soochipara are in Kerala, and Hogenakkal is on the Kaveri.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Kapurthala
Indian Railways' Rail Coach Factory is at Kapurthala in Punjab. Chennai has the Integral Coach Factory, Bengaluru the Rail Wheel Factory and Chittaranjan the Chittaranjan Locomotive Works.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 3.8 tonne
ISRO gives the mass of Chandrayaan-2, put into orbit by the GSLV MkIII-M1 on 22 July 2019, as 3,840 kg, about 3.8 tonnes.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 1946
UNICEF was set up by the UN General Assembly on 11 December 1946, at first to help children after the Second World War.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 80
Uttar Pradesh had 80 seats in the Lok Sabha when the exam was held (March 2020), the most of any state.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Jack Dorsey
Jack Dorsey co-founded Twitter in 2006 with Evan Williams, Biz Stone and Noah Glass. Tim Berners-Lee invented the World Wide Web, N R Narayana Murthy co-founded Infosys and Bill Gates co-founded Microsoft.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Jinson Johnson
In January 2020 Jinson Johnson held the national records in the 800 m, set in 2018, and the 1500 m, set in 2019; both are middle-distance races rather than sprints. Muhammad Anas held the 400 m record, Ayyasamy Dharun the 400 m hurdles and Avinash Sable the 3000 m steeplechase.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Iron oxide
SSC's key gives iron oxide, the constituent that defines laterite: heavy rain and heat leach away lime and silica and leave behind iron oxide, which makes the soil red, and aluminium compounds. The soil is poor in organic matter, nitrogen, phosphate and calcium; NCERT's Class XI text also says potash is in excess, but iron oxide is what laterite is known for.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Shashi Tharoor
'Kerala: God's Own Country' (2002) is Shashi Tharoor's book on Kerala, illustrated with drawings by M F Husain.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Mizoram
The Sixth Schedule provides for autonomous district councils in the tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram. Nagaland, Manipur and Arunachal Pradesh are not covered by it.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 16 September
16 September is the International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer, marking the signing of the Montreal Protocol on that day in 1987.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Half byte
A nibble is 4 bits, half of an 8-bit byte.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Sasaram
Sher Shah Suri's tomb stands in an artificial lake at Sasaram in Bihar, where his family held its jagir. Chausa is where he defeated Humayun in 1539.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Sourav Ganguly
Sourav Ganguly became president of the BCCI in October 2019 and held the post in January 2020. Ravi Shastri was then India's head coach.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Mohanlal Viswanathan
The Malayalam actor Mohanlal (Mohanlal Viswanathan Nair) received the Padma Bhushan in 2019. That year Bhupen Hazarika was given the Bharat Ratna posthumously and Sunil Chhetri the Padma Shri; Virat Kohli received the Padma Shri in 2017.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Ravneet Gill
Ravneet Gill succeeded the co-founder Rana Kapoor as managing director and CEO of YES Bank in March 2019 and held the post in January 2020; in March 2020 the RBI superseded the bank's board. Aditya Puri then headed HDFC Bank and Amitabh Chaudhry Axis Bank.

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